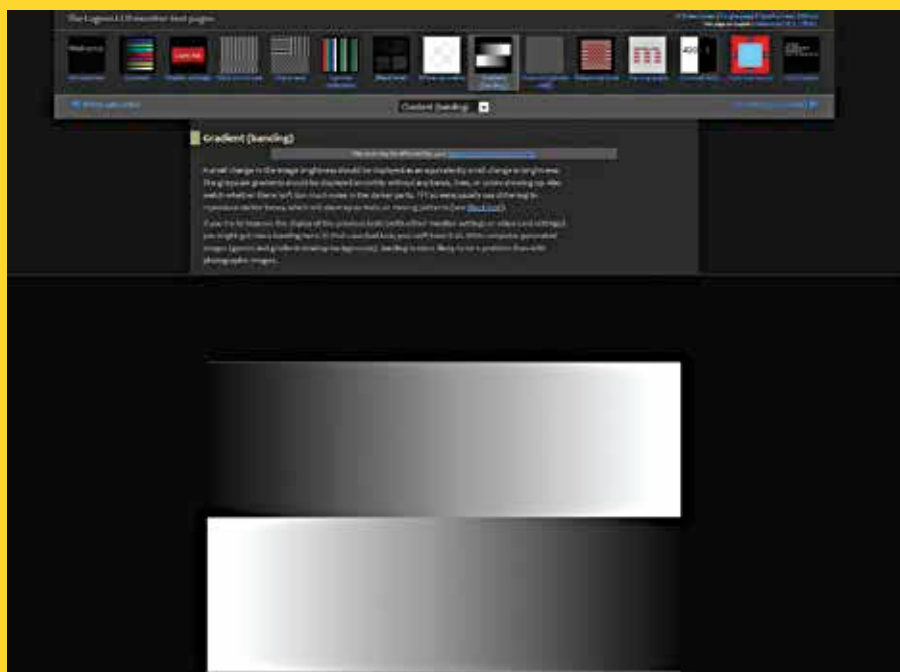


HOW YOU TEST IN A RETAIL STORE

Even if the best deals for all laptops exist online, it's great to make use of offline electronics store to test drive a laptop before purchasing it (or a similar one from its series) online. That way, you're absolutely sure of what you want, and there's no room for second guesses. When in a store, this is what you should look for in a laptop



1 Screen Quality: While a screen's resolution is pretty straightforward and easy to understand, there are other things you should look for, such as its quality. Stand in front of the laptop and tilt its screen back and forth (while keeping your head still). Then, try moving from left to right while keeping the screen stationary. If you notice colour shifts, it's pretty obvious that the laptop doesn't have an IPS display. Colour shifts are entirely dependent on the laptop screen's panel, and while IPS remains the best quality in terms of viewing angles, what you get in a screen depends on how much money you're willing to spend.



3 Screen LCD: If the laptop kept on display in a showroom is connected online, try visiting <http://www.lagom.nl/lcd-test/> through its browser and take the LCD test to determine for yourself how good or bad a laptop's screen is.



2 Screen Brightness: Test the screen's brightness with a light meter app like 'Lux Meter' (<https://goo.gl/x3U52l>) or 'Easy Light Meter' (<https://goo.gl/85W3Kj>). They should give you a fair idea about the screen's brightness. Obviously, the centre of the screen will be its brightest spot, while towards the edges, the screen will be less brighter.



4 Screen Reflectiveness: You won't be able to tell how bad a laptop's screen reflects light falling onto it until you see it in person. Matte screens are the best, whereas glossy screen surfaces (as found on most modern laptops these days) can be quite annoying to work with, like the example shown here.



5 Audio: Copy some of your favourite songs on a pen drive and ask the sales executive at the laptop demo station to allow you to play your songs on the laptop. Generally, don't expect laptop speakers to be of great quality, as you'd be disappointed.